

Welcome to Algatech

Welcome to Algatech. Here's everything you need to get started.

This is the onboarding guide for new colleagues, postdocs, PhD students and guests of Centre Algatech in Třeboň. Whether you're about to start or you're in your first weeks here, this page gives you clear answers to the most common questions. If anything is unclear, just write to your HR contact — **Markéta** for Czech employees, **Jana** for international colleagues. That's exactly what we're here for.



About Centre Algatech

Algatech – Centre of Algal Biotechnology is the largest microalgae research centre in the Czech Republic. We're based in the beautifully restored Opatovický Mill in Třeboň, as a detached facility of the Institute of Microbiology of the Czech Academy of Sciences. We bridge fundamental algal biology and applied biotechnology — and we genuinely enjoy it.



Our five laboratories

- Laboratory of Photosynthesis
- Laboratory of Algal Cell Cycles
- Laboratory of Anoxygenic Phototrophs
- Laboratory of Algal Biotechnology
- Application Laboratory of Algal Technologies



Where to find us

We're located in the historic 18th-century Opatovický Mill, just below the Opatovický pond's dam, a short walk from the centre of Třeboň. The complex was extensively reconstructed in 2009–2014 and today houses laboratories and a fermentation hall.

Address:

Centre Algatech
Institute of Microbiology,
CAS, v. v. i.
Novohradská 237, 379 01
Třeboň, Czech Republic

Tip for day one: you don't need to arrive with everything figured out. A buddy from the team will walk you through the building (and the coffee machine) during your first days.

alga.cz

Institute of Microbiology, CAS



Your first steps with us

No stress, no rigid day-by-day schedule — onboarding here is a friendly process that we walk through together with your supervisor and HR. Here are the main themes we cover along the way.



Before you arrive

We'll agree on your start date, accommodation and who will greet you on day one. Please send us copies of your ID/passport, diploma and CV in advance — it saves the running around on the first day.



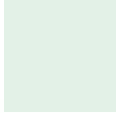
Your arrival and first days

We'll sign the contract together, give you a building tour and introduce you to your supervisor and a lab buddy. You'll get your access card, email, network credentials and key contacts.



What we'll handle together

- We register you with the **District Social Security Administration** (OSSZ) — the employer must report your start within 8 calendar days (Sec. 94, Act 187/2006 Coll. on Sickness Insurance).
- We notify your **public health insurance fund** (within 8 days, Sec. 10, Act 48/1997 Coll.). Just tell us which fund you're insured with.
- We sign the **income tax declaration** with you so you can claim the basic taxpayer credit and any child credit (Sec. 38k, Act 586/1992 Coll. on Income Taxes).



- We set up the attendance system and walk you through using it.
- We show you the canteen, library, shared spaces and facilities.
- We hand over the key info on payroll, leave (6 weeks/year) and benefits.



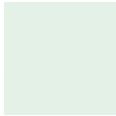
Residence formalities (if you're coming from abroad)

HR will guide you through any residence-related steps — registration with the Foreign Police, OAMP appointments at the Ministry of Interior and follow-up paperwork. We coordinate the timing together so you don't have to figure it out alone, and we'll go with you when it helps.

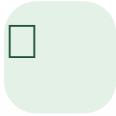


Lab induction

Before you start lab work, you'll do the mandatory occupational-health-and-safety and fire-safety training. Your supervisor and lab buddy will gradually walk you



through equipment, chemicals and notebook conventions
— no instrument is used without local training.



Settling into Třeboň

Among the first steps are registering with a GP, opening a bank account and getting to know the town. The "Practical info" and "Life in Třeboň" sections have tips and contacts.

Important: there are no silly questions. If any step doesn't make sense, just write it in the [HR form below](#) — Markéta (Czech employees) or Jana (international colleagues). We'd rather double-check than have anything catch you off guard.



Key contacts

For Czech employees, your first contact is **Markéta**; for international colleagues, **Jana**. If you're not sure, just write to either of us — we'll route it. Really.



HR · Jana

Jana Budínová

HR contact for the whole centre, primarily for **international colleagues** and relocation. Helps with onboarding, on-site accommodation, residence and visa formalities (Foreign Police, OAMP), authority paperwork and routing you to the right person at the centre.

☎ [+420 724 874 274](tel:+420724874274)



HR · Markéta

Markéta Stefanová

HR contact for **Czech employees**. Helps with onboarding, employment contract, **entry medical examination, attendance**, payroll, tax forms, leave records and day-to-day life at the centre.

☎ [+420 384 340 415](tel:+420384340415)



stefanova@alga.cz



Centre management

Director: Prof. Ing. Roman Sobotka, Ph.D.

Centre Manager: Ing. Tomáš Budín

☎ [+420 384 340 412](tel:+420384340412)

✉ info@alga.cz



budinova@alga.cz

Your lab head / supervisor is your first contact for the science — experimental plans, equipment access and evaluations. HR handles the employment side — from your start through holidays and beyond.



Salary, attendance & leave

A short orientation in how the working day, payroll and leave work here.



Salary and payslip

Net salary = gross – social security – health insurance – sickness insurance – income tax + applied tax reliefs.

Salary lands on your Czech bank account by the 10th of the following month. You'll receive a monthly payslip.



Working hours

Full-time is 40 hours per week. We work with flexible hours — the daily core is agreed with your supervisor.

Lab work naturally follows experiments, so stay in close touch with your team.



Attendance

Each person records their own attendance in the electronic system. Absences — leave, sickness, home office, business trips, conferences — are agreed with your supervisor and marked in the system. HR closes the monthly record.



Annual leave

Our employees receive **6 weeks of paid annual leave** per year (pro-rated for part-time or partial year). Plan it with your supervisor in advance — especially around key experiments and conferences.



Sick leave & doctor visits

If you can't come in, let your supervisor and HR know as soon as possible. For longer illness, your GP issues an electronic sick note that is sent automatically to us and to the social-security office.



Benefits

Meal contribution (paid through payroll), performance bonuses, conference travel support, language courses on request, and access to the Czech Academy of Sciences benefits programme.



Personal income tax (2026)

A short overview of the most common questions. Specific cases — multiple employers, additional contracts, deductions — are always handled by payroll (Markéta) or a tax advisor.



2026 rates and basic relief

Two-rate progressive tax: **15%** up to the legal threshold (about CZK 1.76 million/year) and **23%** above. Standard taxpayer relief for 2026 is **CZK 30,840** per year.



Employee mandatory contributions

From gross salary: **7.1%** social + **4.5%** health + **0.6%** sickness insurance. The employer pays its share on top.



Annual settlement vs. own return

If you have only one employer for the whole year, payroll usually performs the annual settlement. With multiple employers, additional income or non-standard reliefs, you file your own return — typically by 1 April (with extensions for electronic filing or via a tax advisor).



Family reliefs and common deductions

Child credits in 2026: ~CZK 15,204 (1st), 22,320 (2nd), 27,840 (3rd+). Spouse relief CZK 24,840 if spouse earns under CZK 68,000/year and cares for a child under 3. Plus deductions for donations, supplementary pension, life insurance and selected housing-loan interest.

Tax residence (for international colleagues)

If your permanent home or centre of vital interests is in the Czech Republic, or you spend at least 183 days here in a calendar year, you're typically a Czech tax resident. Otherwise — non-resident, taxed only on Czech-source income. Double-tax treaties may apply to your home country.

Certificate of tax domicile

If you need to prove Czech tax residence to a foreign tax authority, you can apply for a Certificate of Tax Domicile at your local tax office. HR will issue the employment confirmation you need to attach.

Rates, thresholds and deadlines change every year. Markéta always uses the current valid version — if you're unsure, just ask.

financnisprava.cz

PwC · Czech individual tax



Residence & visa — we go through it together

If you're moving to the Czech Republic, the residence side of things looks more complicated than it really is — because we walk through it with you. HR coordinates the visits to the Foreign Police and the OAMP office (Ministry of Interior), helps with appointments and is happy to come along when it's useful.



EU / EFTA citizens

No visa or work permit is needed. For longer stays, a Certificate of Temporary Residence is recommended — it makes banking, healthcare and family registrations much smoother. We help you prepare the application and book the OAMP appointment.



Researchers from third countries

The standard pathway is the long-term residence permit for the purpose of scientific research, based on a Hosting Agreement we issue. The permit is valid up to 2 years and gives free access to the Czech labour market — no separate work permit. HR prepares the hosting agreement together with you.



Non-research staff from third countries

For technical, administrative and other non-research roles, the typical permit is the Employee Card (zaměstnanecká karta) — a combined work-and-



Registering your address (HR coordinates)

Once you arrive, your place of residence needs to be registered. We don't leave you to handle this alone — HR coordinates the Foreign

residence permit. HR coordinates the steps with you.

Police and OAMP visits, helps with the timing and gets the right paperwork ready.



Biometrics & residence card

After arrival you'll book a Ministry of Interior appointment for biometrics (fingerprints and a photo). The biometric residence card is then ready to collect within roughly 30–60 days. HR helps you set this up and reminds you of follow-up steps.



Family members

A spouse, registered partner and minor children can apply for residence on family-reunion grounds, linked to your status. We can help you prepare the document checklist (marriage and birth certificates with apostille or superlegalisation, certified Czech translations).

The short version: just keep us in the loop on your travel dates. HR handles the legwork on appointments, paperwork and timing — you focus on settling in.

EURAXESS Czech Republic

Czech Immigration Portal

Ministry of Interior (MV ČR)



Lab culture

A few simple habits that help you settle in quickly and work safely.



Say hi, ask anything

Greet colleagues when entering rooms or offices. We work in two languages — feel free to ask people to slow down or switch to English.



Train before you touch

No instrument is used without local training and supervisor approval — even if you've used a similar one elsewhere. **SOPs** (Standard Operating Procedures — written step-by-step protocols posted in the lab) and the lab notebook are not optional.



Shared resources

Use the equipment and consumables of your own group. If you need something from another lab, ask the responsible person first. Where there's a booking system, use it.



Report issues immediately

Freezer alarms, water leaks,



Borrow responsibly

Return borrowed items on time. If you

part of safety

broken glass,
unusual smells
— report to your
lab manager
and
maintenance
straight away.
Faster reporting
= less damage.

Personal
hygiene and a
tidy bench are
part of **BOZP**
(occupational
health & safety):
wipe up spills
you create, don't
leave wet floors
behind you, and
please **stay
home if you
feel unwell** —
protecting
colleagues and
shared
equipment
matters.

need to keep
them longer,
leave a clear
note. Same
applies to
literature and
shared drives.

 **We're
direct —
please be
direct too**

Czech
communication
tends to be
straightforward.
It's perfectly
normal — and
welcome — to
**ask about
money directly**
(e.g. "you
covered my

 **It's OK to
push back**

The hierarchy is
clear, but talking
openly with your
supervisor is
expected and
welcome. If
you're already
running an
experiment and
can't realistically
start another
one in parallel,
say so — even

 **Aim for
independence**

Take notes, ask
questions and
write your own
SOPs. The goal
is for you to feel
confident and
safe working
independently
as soon as
possible.

lunch, how much do I owe you?"). What can feel impolite in some cultures is the everyday way here. The same goes for borrowed items, deadlines or favours: a clear, friendly reminder is appreciated, not rude.

(especially) to your boss. "I have other work right now, I'll get to it on Thursday" is a perfectly fine answer. Don't agree to something you can't deliver; that creates more friction than honesty does.



Practical info for daily life

A few useful things for the first weeks in Třeboň.



Bank account

Salary is paid to a Czech bank account. In Třeboň you'll find branches of **Česká spořitelna** and **ČSOB** — both are fine for opening an account and a card. Bring your ID/passport and your employment contract.



Phone and internet

Prepaid SIM or contract with O2, T-Mobile or Vodafone. Třeboň has solid 4G/5G and fibre coverage — for home internet, ask your accommodation provider.



Doctors and pharmacies

After joining us, register with a GP, dentist and (for women) gynaecologist as soon as possible.

Recommended GP:

Dr. Jana Tichá —
ordinace.wordpress.com

Dentist: Dr. Karel Závodský (Roudné, near České Budějovice). Dental emergencies: České Budějovice 7.



Transport

By train or bus to České Budějovice in ~30 min, to Prague ~2.5 h, to Vienna ~3 h. Around town and the ponds, a bike works really well. Schedules: idos.cz.

Centre cars and ride-

sharing: we run an internal car-booking system (5 vehicles). Markéta or HR will share the rules and calendar with you.

Most prescriptions are electronic (eRecept) — collect at any pharmacy with your ID and the SMS code.

Groceries

Supermarkets in Třeboň:

- Kaufland — Jiráskova 1315
- Penny Market — Táboritská 1195 and U Francouzů 1181
- Terno — Nádražní 641

Online grocery delivery:

[Tesco Online](#), [Rohlík.cz](#), [Košík.cz](#).

Plus farmers' markets, bakeries, drugstores (Rossmann, Teta) and the post office (Česká pošta). Cards are accepted almost everywhere.

Mail and packages

If you live in the centre's accommodation, you can have **packages delivered to Novohradská 237, 379 01 Třeboň**. The courier leaves them at the gatehouse and you can pick them up after working hours.

On-site accommodation

If you're staying in our centre accommodation, cleaning (sweeping/mopping) is done

Wi-Fi and internal credentials

Wi-Fi, email, attendance and other internal passwords will be handed over to you **in**

once a week. For anything broken (taps, light bulbs, handles), please contact **Jana** — she'll arrange the repair.

Looking for long-term housing? Try [Sreality.cz](#), [Bezrealitky.cz](#) or [Expats.cz](#).

person on your first day.

For security reasons we don't share them by email or on this page.



Tax domicile certificate

If you need a Czech **Tax Domicile Certificate** (confirmation of Czech tax residency), you apply at your local Financial Office. HR can help with the paperwork — just ask Jana or Markéta.



Emergency numbers

112 — single emergency number (English supported)
155 — medical emergency
158 — police · **150** — fire



Life in Třeboň

Třeboň is a small historic town in South Bohemia, surrounded by ponds, forests and a UNESCO biosphere reserve. A calm pace, nature on the doorstep and a strong cultural tradition.



Nature and sport

Cycle paths and walking trails around the famous fishponds (Svět, Rožmberk), through pine forests and peat bogs. Swimming, running, paddling and ice-skating are favourites among the team.



Culture and history

Renaissance castle, historic square, brewery and the Schwarzenberg tomb are within walking distance. Třeboň is famous for autumn pond harvests, summer concerts and the film festival.



Spa and wellness

Třeboň is a traditional peat-spa town. [Třeboň Spa](#) has pools, saunas and procedures open to residents too — perfect for unwinding. There's also **Fitness na Kraji Světa** and **Fitness Třeboň** for regular workouts.



Family and schools

There are nurseries, kindergartens, primary and secondary schools. Nursery capacity is limited — apply early. International schools are available in České Budějovice and Prague.

Day trips nearby

České Budějovice, Český Krumlov, Hluboká Castle, the Šumava mountains and the Austrian border are an easy drive away. Vienna and Prague are a few hours by car.

Where to eat

Favourite spots among colleagues, all in Třeboň:

- [Curry House](#) — Indian
- Oregano — Italian
- Sahara
- Krčma u Kellyho
- Bistro 105

Plus the local Regent brewery and cafés on the main square.

Culture in town

In Třeboň you'll find **Cinema Třeboň**, **Galerie 105** and seasonal events on the main square. Local traditions include the autumn pond harvests, summer concerts and the film festival.

Czech language

English is widely used at the centre, but a bit of Czech makes daily life much easier. For international colleagues, we're happy to arrange a language course — just write to Jana.

Welcome to Třeboň. The Algatech team is glad to have you — please bring any question, however small, to HR.



Ask us a question

Choose who you'd like to reach — for **Czech employees**, your first contact is Markéta; for **international colleagues**, Jana. When you submit, your email client will open with a pre-filled message. We usually reply within two working days.



Jana — HR for international colleagues

Write to Jana if you're an international colleague — residence, visa, Foreign Police, on-site accommodation, relocation to Třeboň, or anything related to authority paperwork.

Prefer a call? Phone Jana at [+420 724 874 274](tel:+420724874274) (Mon–Fri).



Markéta — HR for Czech employees

Write to Markéta if you're a Czech employee — onboarding, employment contract, entry medical exam, attendance, payroll, tax forms or leave records.

Prefer a call? Phone Markéta at [+420 384 340 415](tel:+420384340415) (Mon–Fri).

Centre Algatech — Institute of Microbiology, CAS, v. v. i. · Novohradská 237, 379 01 Třeboň, Czech Republic · www.alga.cz

This page is informational. We'll always confirm current procedures together — with HR: **Markéta Stefanová** (Czech employees) or **Jana Budínová** (international colleagues), or the relevant authority. Last updated April 2026.

Czech version: algatech-vitejte.html